

Where Have All the Male Therapists Gone?

REVIEW

WSJ

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A federal judge threw out** a pair of subpoenas the Justice Department issued to the Fed, handing the central bank a victory and dealing a blow to U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro's criminal investigation into Chair Jerome Powell. **A1**
- ◆ **The Fed's preferred** inflation gauge remained stuck above the central bank's target in January, indicating that policymakers are likely to keep interest rates steady next week. **A2**
- ◆ **All three major U.S.** stock indexes logged a weekly decline of more than 1.2% and on Friday the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow shed 0.6%, 0.9% and 0.3%, respectively. **B10**
- ◆ **Amazon Web Services** plans to deploy processors designed by Cerebras inside its data centers, a vote of confidence in the supplier of chips that power AI models. **B9**
- ◆ **Apple cut the fees it** collects from app developers in China, a rare move aimed at defusing a brewing regulatory showdown there. **B9**
- ◆ **Organizers of Dubai's** flagship crypto conference, which was to feature Eric Trump as a speaker, scrapped this year's meeting because of the Iran war. **B10**
- ◆ **FedEx eclipsed rival UPS** in market capitalization, a laurel for shrinking operations to boost profit. **B9**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The Pentagon is moving** more Marines and warships to the Middle East as Iran steps up its attacks on the Strait of Hormuz and the U.S. prepares to escort tankers through the waterway. **A1, A6-8**
- ◆ **Trump said the U.S.** "obliterated" military targets on Iran's Kharg Island. Central Command confirmed six U.S. crew members died in a refueling aircraft that went down Thursday in western Iraq. **A6**
- ◆ **Before war began,** Trump was told that Iran would likely close the Strait of Hormuz in response to an attack but he ordered it anyway. **A1, A7**
- ◆ **The White House is** more tightly controlling the messaging and policies coming from HHS ahead of the midterm elections, including those concerning vaccines. **A1**
- ◆ **The family of the man** who rammed his vehicle into a synagogue near Detroit died in Lebanon during an Israeli attack, a local mayor said. **A5**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is set to receive a roughly \$10 billion fee from investors in the deal to take control of TikTok's U.S. business. **A4**

- ◆ **Adults should be** screened and treated for high cholesterol starting at age 30, new guidance urges. **A3**
- ◆ **A jury convicted** eight people on terrorism charges over a shooting at a Texas immigration facility. **A5**

WEEKEND INTERVIEW

Ben Sasse
faces a public death **A11**

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U.S. Sends More Forces to Gulf

By LARA SELIGMAN
AND SHELBY HOLLIDAY

The Pentagon is moving additional Marines and warships to the Middle East, as Iran steps up its attacks on the Strait of Hormuz and the U.S. prepares to escort tankers through the waterway.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth has approved a request from U.S. Central Command, responsible for U.S. forces in the Middle East, for an element of an amphibious-ready group and attached Ma-

rine expeditionary unit to head to the region, according to U.S. officials.

Two ships from the Japan-based USS Tripoli Amphibious Ready Group and the 31st Marine Expeditionary Unit are now headed for the Middle East, one of the officials said. Marines are already in the Middle East supporting the Iran operation, and several more flights of Marines have moved into the theater in recent days, according to flight tracking data and U.S. officials.

The move comes as Iran's

attacks on the strait have paralyzed traffic through the strategic waterway since the start of the war, disrupting the global economy, driving up gasoline prices and posing a major military and political challenge for President Trump. The U.S. said it would release 172 million barrels of oil from the Strategic Petroleum Reserve, a rare emergency measure aimed at bringing down crude prices.

A Pentagon spokesperson declined to comment. One of the officials said the additional as-

sets would initially be involved in strike operations on Iran. The USS Tripoli is equipped with F-35B jump-jet fighters.

An amphibious-ready group is a fast-response unit used to conduct sea-based assaults, humanitarian-aid missions and special operations. The group's embarked Marine expeditionary unit includes more than 2,000 Marines.

In addition to the Marine unit, the Pentagon is also weighing Centcom's request for two additional destroyers

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DOJ Suffers Big Blow In Powell Probe

Judge tosses Fed subpoenas, says aim was to harass; U.S. attorney to appeal

By NICK TIMIRAO
AND C. RYAN BARBER

WASHINGTON—A federal judge threw out a pair of subpoenas the Justice Department issued to the Federal Reserve, handing a victory to the central bank and dealing a heavy blow to U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro's criminal investigation into Chair Jerome Powell.

U.S. District Judge James Boasberg ruled that the subpoenas were improper, in a 27-page opinion unsealed Friday that highlighted President Trump's repeated public attacks on Powell.

"There is abundant evidence that the subpoenas' dominant (if not sole) purpose is to harass and pressure Powell either to yield to the President or to resign and make way for a Fed Chair who will," Boasberg, who was appointed by former President Barack Obama, wrote.

The judge said the government had produced "essentially zero evidence" that Powell had committed a crime.

Pirro, the U.S. attorney for the District of Columbia and a longtime ally of Trump, opened the probe to examine whether Powell gave false testimony to Congress last summer about the central bank's building-renovation project. The move prompted an unprecedented public response from Powell, who in a Jan. 11 video statement said the investigation was a pretext for Trump's continuing campaign to pressure the Fed to lower interest rates and end the independence of the central bank.

Pirro vowed on Friday to appeal. She called Boasberg an "activist judge" and said the decision "neutered" the grand jury's ability to investigate crime.

"As a result, Jerome Powell today is now bathed in immunity, preventing my office from investigating the Federal Reserve," Pirro said. "This is wrong, and it is without legal authority."

The Wall Street Journal had previously reported that the Fed was mounting a behind-closed-doors legal challenge

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Rescuers searched for survivors Friday after an airstrike in southern Tehran. Iran continued its defiance in the face of U.S.-Israeli attacks. Several leaders appeared in pro-regime rallies, while the country has essentially shut down the Strait of Hormuz.

President Knew the Risk of Closure Of Hormuz Strait, Still Went to War

WASHINGTON—Before the U.S. went to war, Gen. Dan Caine, the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, told President Trump that an American

By Alexander Ward,
Lara Seligman,
Alex Leary and
Vera Bergengruen

attack could prompt Iran to close the Strait of Hormuz.

Caine said in several briefings that U.S. officials had long believed Iran would deploy mines, drones and mis-

siles to close the world's most vital shipping lane, according to people with knowledge of the discussions.

Trump acknowledged the risk, these people said, but moved forward with the most consequential foreign-policy decision of his two presidencies. He told his team that Tehran would likely capitulate before closing the strait—and even if Iran tried, the U.S. military could handle it.

Now, two weeks into the war, Iran's leaders have refused to back down, and the

Strait of Hormuz has emerged as Tehran's most potent leverage point.

Iran has blocked tankers from the strait and struck cargo ships, triggering a surge in oil prices and an energy shock rippling around the world. U.S. forces are targeting Iran's mine-laying ships and factories, trying to prevent the country from lining the waterway with explosives.

The joint U.S.-Israel military operation has killed Iran's supreme leader and targeted missile and mine factories,

and military headquarters. It also damaged or destroyed more than 90 Iranian vessels.

Yet, the price has been steep. At least 13 Americans have been killed, including six in a crash Thursday of an Air Force refueling plane, making the war in Iran the deadliest military operation of Trump's two terms. At least 140 Americans have been wounded in the conflict. Roughly 175 people, mostly children, were killed in a strike on a girls' school in Iran, which a preliminary U.S.

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Global trade	Strait of Hormuz	Economy	Gulf states
Iran war is rippling through supply chains. A6	Naval mines give Tehran outsize power. A7	U.S. consumers feel some pain from war. A7	Region's image of luxurious safe haven unravels. A8

Team Italy Takes Over Baseball With Espresso Shots and Armani

* * *

Italian-American players win over fans with their enthusiastic embrace of the homeland

By JARED DIAMOND

Dominic Canzone had just launched a titanic home run for Italy in the World Baseball Classic, so he knew what awaited him after he rounded the bases: a scalding shot of espresso, made right in the dugout.

"Burned the roof of my mouth," he said afterward. "Still recovering from that."

Coffee temperature has been pretty much the only complaint for Team Italy over the past week. The Azzurri, as they are known, have emerged as the unlikely darlings of the WBC. After a four-game sweep of the opening round, which included a historic upset of

the U.S., they are one of three undefeated teams at the tournament, alongside baseball powerhouses Japan and the Dominican Republic. They will take on Puerto Rico on Saturday in a quarterfinal that fans are already dubbing the third act of "West Side Story."

A bigger challenge than winning ballgames, it turns out, has been understanding the nuances of Italian culture. That's because Italy's roster has one glaring omission—actual Italians.

Baseball is a niche sport in soccer-crazed Italy. Only two born-and-raised Italians have ever reached the majors. And only three players participat-

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EXCHANGE

\$40 BILLION INDUSTRY

The one store winning at youth sports. **B1**

White House Puts RFK on Tight Leash

By LIZ ESSLEY WHYTE
AND NATALIE ANDREWS

WASHINGTON—The White House is more tightly controlling the messaging and policies coming from the Health and Human Services Department ahead of the midterm elections, including around vaccines, people familiar with the matter said.

Aides close to President Trump decided to take a more active role in managing Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s department in the face of polling that shows his vaccine moves are unpopular, the people said. Although Trump brought Kennedy into his administration with the promise the vaccine skeptic and ultraprocessed-food critic could "go wild on health," administration officials grew frustrated with what they

viewed as mistakes inside Kennedy's department, people familiar with the matter said. Aides close to Trump grew worried that perceived disorganization and a focus on vaccines could hurt Republicans in November, those people said.

Some people close to Kennedy and the White House said the secretary's standing among some staff is at a new low following a series of setbacks for his Make America Healthy Again agenda. But Kennedy continues to be in good standing with the president himself, people familiar with their relationship said.

Trump signed an executive order last month that sought to boost production of the herbicide glyphosate for national security purposes, angering many of Kennedy's backers. Trump

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